

ALEX CARTER

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SUMMARY

Full-stack software engineer with 2 years of experience building and scaling consumer-facing web applications, from React frontends to Node.js/Go backends deployed on cloud infrastructure. Comfortable owning features end-to-end, from database schema design to CI/CD deployment. Strong background in data pipelines and event-driven systems from an internship in ad-tech analytics. Looking to join a product engineering team where I can grow into a senior full-stack or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript/TypeScript, Go, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS
Frontend: React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Vite, Webpack
Backend & Data: Node.js, Express, Go (Gin), GraphQL, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Kafka, Apache Airflow
Infrastructure: AWS (ECS, RDS, S3, CloudWatch), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Datadog
Core Concepts: Microservices, event-driven architecture, CI/CD, A/B testing, unit/e2e testing (Jest, Playwright), Agile/Scrum

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer — Brightloop (Series B fintech startup) Aug 2024 – Present

Austin, TX

- Built a self-serve onboarding flow in React/Next.js that reduced average signup-to-first-transaction time from 11 minutes to 4 minutes, contributing to a 19% lift in activation rate.
- Migrated a monolithic Express API into 3 independent Go microservices behind an API gateway, cutting p95 latency on the payments endpoint from 640ms to 190ms.
- Designed and shipped a real-time notifications service using Kafka and WebSockets, now handling 50,000+ events/day in production.
- Set up Terraform-managed infrastructure and a GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline, reducing average deploy time from 25 minutes to 6 minutes.

Data Engineering Intern — AdPulse Analytics May 2023 – Aug 2023

Remote

- Built an Apache Airflow pipeline that ingested and cleaned 2M+ daily ad-impression events from 4 external partner APIs into a PostgreSQL warehouse.
- Wrote Python ETL scripts that cut a manual weekly reporting process from 3 hours to under 10 minutes.
- Created a Grafana dashboard surfacing campaign performance metrics for the sales team, adopted as their primary daily reporting tool.
- Identified and fixed a data-duplication bug in the ingestion layer that had inflated impression counts by roughly 8%.

PROJECTS

SplitStay — Group Travel Expense Splitter | *React Native, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Stripe API*

- Built a cross-platform mobile app (iOS/Android) that lets groups track shared trip expenses and settle balances automatically, with 400+ downloads since launch.
- Implemented real-time balance syncing across devices using WebSockets and optimistic UI updates.
- Integrated Stripe Connect for direct peer-to-peer settlements between users.

DevPulse — GitHub Team Activity Dashboard | *Next.js, GraphQL, Redis, GitHub API*

- Built a dashboard that visualizes PR review times, commit activity, and code-ownership hotspots for engineering teams.
- Cached GitHub API responses in Redis to reduce external API calls by 85% and keep the dashboard within rate limits for teams of 50+ repos.
- Open-sourced the project, reaching 220+ GitHub stars.

ShelfSense — Personal Library Tracker | *React, Express, MongoDB, Google Books API*

- Built a full-stack app for cataloging personal book collections via barcode scan, auto-fetching metadata from the Google Books API.
- Implemented full-text search and tagging, letting users filter a 1,000+ book library in under 100ms client-side.

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin — B.S. in Computer Science May 2023

Austin, TX | GPA: 3.62/4.0 | Minor in Business

- Relevant Coursework: Distributed Systems, Database Systems, Software Engineering, Computer Networks, Algorithms, Cloud Computing

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (2024) • HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate (2024) • freeCodeCamp — Full Stack Web Development (2022)